Stakeholder needs: desk research with sources

What this is. A synthesis of public research, surveys, regulation and bank disclosures, organised by the four stakeholder roles, to stand in for interviews until real ones are held. **It is not interview evidence.** Each line says what the need is, the number behind it, where the number comes from, and how trustworthy that source is. Vendor figures are labelled: vendors have a reason to make the pain look large, so they bracket a number, they do not prove it. Researched on 9 November 2026.

Source quality: **[R]** regulator or law; **[B]** bank disclosure; **[S]** independent or industry survey; **[A]** academic / peer-reviewed; **[V]** vendor material (incentive to inflate); **[N]** news report of a bank's own claim.

1. Users: credit analysts and relationship managers

Need	Evidence	Source	What it means for DocPipe
Less time keying statements	Manual spreading takes about 2-6 analyst hours per borrower, depending on entity complexity and the number of guarantors; a three-year spread can take a senior analyst 3-5 hours	[V] Scry AI; [V] FintechSpecs	The business case uses 60 minutes per statement file, the *low* end of this range, to stay conservative
A measured "after" from a real lender	Spreading complex statements fell from 3-4 hours to 30-45 minutes at a credit union after automation	[V] nCino customer case study	Consistent with DocPipe's design (machine reads, analyst reviews flagged items); still a vendor case
More time with customers	RMs are said to spend up to 60-70% of their time on administrative work; only 25-30% in direct client dialogue	[V] Backbase (attributes it to McKinsey, study not located); [V] Vis Banking	Treated as directional only; the pilot measures the real share with time sampling
Find documents and answers fast	Knowledge workers spend about 1.8 hours a day (about 19% of the week) searching for and gathering information	[S] McKinsey Global Institute, *The social economy* (2012), as cited by Cottrill Research	Justifies the cited Q&A and the predictable folder layout; not banking-specific
Trust what the tool produces	Manual transcription error rates range from about 0.5% to over 10% depending on the field; numeric fields around 1%	[A] peer-reviewed clinical data-entry studies summarised in PMC6351970	Manual keying is not error-free: the baseline error rate must be measured (week 1) before claiming the tool is better

Synthesised persona (from the sources above, not a person). A corporate credit analyst spends a few hours per borrower re-keying statements and re-checking totals, and more time hunting for the right version of a contract or registration. They will use a tool only if they can see the source page next to each value; otherwise checking it costs as much as doing it.

2. Process owner: credit operations

Need	Evidence	Source	What it means for DocPipe
Faster onboarding, fewer lost clients	70% of financial institutions lost clients in the past year because onboarding was slow; abandonment averages about 10%; UK corporate banks report onboarding often over six weeks (survey of 600 decision-makers, August 2025)	[S/V] Fenergo *Financial Crime Industry Trends 2025*, reported by Crowdfund Insider and FinTech Global	Speed of document handling is a commercial issue, not only a cost issue
Lower cost per file	Banks took on average 95 days to complete a corporate KYC review in 2023 (84 days the year before); over half spend USD 1,500-3,000 per client KYC review	[S/V] Fenergo 2023 study of 1,100+ executives, via A-Team Insight	Document reading and filing is a slice of this cost; DocPipe does not claim the whole of it
Proof that it works in Vietnam	MB reports its DocAI cut document-checking time by 75% and serves 350,000+ businesses on Biz MBBank; MB reported SME credit processing falling from about 10 days to 2; VietBank reports 35% shorter approval time with in-house AI; MSB digitised credit approval using national tax and invoice data	[N] The Investor, Báo Nghệ An, ecosistemastartup, Pulse, The Investor	Competitors are already doing this: "do nothing" has a competitive cost. All figures are the banks' own claims

Need	Evidence	Source	What it means for DocPipe
Volume that keeps growing	Vietnam registered 195,100 new enterprises in 2025 (+24.1%), plus 92,900 returning in the first ten months	[N] National Statistics Office figures via Vietstock and VOV	More new business customers means more onboarding documents per year
Scale at Techcombank	~18.0 million customers, 2.7 million added in 2025; corporate credit VND 452.1 trillion (+13.4%); retail credit including SME VND 372.0 trillion (+30.8%); cost-to-income ratio 30.8%	[B] Techcombank FY2025 results press release	A bank this size, with an already low cost-to-income ratio, gains from capacity (handling growth without more headcount) more than from cost cuts

Synthesised persona. An operations lead wants every credit file named and filed the same way, a review queue that does not grow faster than reviewers can clear it, and a number showing time per file falling. Their red line is a tool that creates a second queue they have to staff.

3. Risk and compliance

Need	Evidence	Source	What it means for DocPipe
A legal basis before personal data leaves Vietnam	Personal Data Protection Law 91/2025/QH15, in force 1 January 2026: cross-border transfers need a transfer impact assessment dossier filed with the authority (A05); fines for cross-border violations up to 5% of the previous year's revenue	[R] summarised by Tilleke & Gibbins, Allen & Gledhill, Vietnam Briefing	Sending page images to a hosted model abroad triggers this; the in-bank endpoint is a gate before any non-public document
AI rules specific to banking	SBV Circular 53/2026/TT-NHNN (issued 30 September 2026, effective 15 November 2026): classify every AI system by risk before deployment, keep an inventory reviewed at least yearly, notify customers when AI interacts with them	[R] Luat Viet Nam, VNBA, Vietnam News	DocPipe needs a risk-classification dossier before the pilot; it is internal-facing (no customer interaction), which should keep it out of the strictest tier, to be confirmed
Responsibility stays with the bank	The draft circular said banks remain "fully responsible for the safety and compliance" of outsourced AI, must audit vendors, log AI operations, and report serious incidents to the SBV within 24 hours	[R] draft text summarised by Baker McKenzie (final text to be checked)	The audit log, monitoring alerts, kill switch and model/prompt versioning map directly onto these duties
Replayable decisions	Customers can ask for human review of AI decisions; disputed outputs need human reassessment (draft circular)	[R] same as above	Every DocPipe decision is logged with its reasons and can be re-run, corrected or rolled back by a named person

Synthesised persona. A compliance officer asks: which model saw this document, which version, where did the data go, can I replay the decision, and who approved it? Their red lines: personal data abroad without a filed assessment, and an AI system missing from the inventory.

4. Technology and data

Need	Evidence	Source	What it means for DocPipe
Swappable model, no lock-in	The bank's investment is concentrated in IT: FY2025 operating expenses rose 6.9%, "primarily driven by" IT infrastructure	[B] Techcombank FY2025 press release	Fits a gateway (LiteLLM) in front of any model, hosted or in-bank
Clear licences	OpenViking is AGPL-3.0 (licence file read)	Own check of the repository	Legal review before production; the adapter keeps the knowledge base replaceable
Vietnamese document AI is a known category	Local vendors (FPT.AI, GreenNode, Lac Viet) market OCR and document processing for Vietnamese banking documents	[V] FPT.AI, GreenNode, Lac Viet	"Buy" is a real option: run one vendor on the same evaluation set during the pilot

5. Where the roles conflict (from the evidence)

Conflict	Evidence on each side	Design response
Speed (operations, users) vs control (risk)	Clients are lost to slow onboarding (Fenergo 2025) / the bank stays fully responsible for AI outputs (SBV draft)	Automate only what passes deterministic checks; everything else goes to a person with the page shown
Best model (technology, users) vs data location (risk)	Hosted models are the most capable today / PDPL cross-border assessment, fines up to 5% of revenue	Public documents only on the hosted route; in-bank endpoint before pilot
Automation savings (operations) vs verification cost (users)	Manual keying has its own 1-10% error rates (clinical studies) / a tool that must be fully re-checked saves nothing	Measure both: the baseline error rate in week 1, and reviewer minutes per flagged document

6. What the interviews still have to settle

The desk research cannot answer these; they are the first five interviews (`docs/interview-notes.md`): 1. Minutes per statement spread and per onboarding document **at Techcombank**: the input the business case is most sensitive to. 2. Monthly volume of corporate and SME credit files by document type. 3. The current error and rework rate on keyed statements. 4. Which model endpoints and data locations risk will approve, and how Circular 53 classifies an internal document tool. 5. Where documents live today (DMS, shared drives, loan-origination system) and the integration point.

Stakeholder map and evidence

> Cited desk research per role (needs, numbers, sources, quality labels) is in `docs/stakeholder-research.md`; it replaces the uncited parts below where they differ.

Status of evidence: no real interview has been done. Everything below is either a public source (cited, mostly vendor material with an incentive to inflate pain) or a simulated persona built from those sources. The brief asks for 5+ people across 3+ roles; the plan, questions and a notes template are in `docs/interview-notes.md`.

Evidence labels: **[Public]** cited source, **[Sim]** simulated persona (my inference from public sources, not a person).

Roles, interests, conflicts

Role	Wants	Fears	Evidence
Credit analyst / relationship manager (user)	Less keying and hunting for pages; trustworthy numbers; speed	Being blamed for tool errors; verification that costs as much as doing it by hand	[Public] vendor sources put a manual spread at 30-60 min (LenderAnalyzer) to 3-6 h (Aloan) or 4-6 h (Uptiq) per borrower, 2-4 h in others; keying errors, inconsistent templates, junior analysts spending time on entry. [Public] f2.ai: manual verification of automated output "can take as long as the workflow would have if just done manually".
Credit operations / process owner	Throughput, standard folders and naming, SLAs, capacity	Exception queues that grow; inconsistent files across analysts	[Public] Uptiq: for teams doing 15-20 deals a month spreading can take 40-60% of analyst time (vendor-modelled). [Public] Aloan: for smaller banks the bottleneck is analyst capacity.
Risk and compliance	Traceability from source page to decision; access control; no data leaving without a legal basis	Silent numeric errors; model changes that nobody reviewed; personal data in a foreign API	[Public] examiners want to reconstruct how a bank got from source documents to a decision (Aloan, on US SR 26-2 / OCC 2026-13; US guidance, not Vietnamese). [Public, Vietnam, secondary sources] Personal Data Protection Law 91/2025/QH15 and Decree 356/2025/ND-CP (effective 1 Jan 2026): cross-border transfers need an impact assessment filed with the authority; Circular 53/2026/TT-NHNN on AI in banking says outsourcing does not shift responsibility and asks vendors to be assessed for data-protection compliance. Full texts not read; confirm with legal.
Technology / data	Low maintenance, swappable components, data control, clear license	Vendor lock-in; AGPL surprise; unowned model drift	[Public] OpenViking is AGPL-3.0 (LICENSE file read). [Own finding] provider-side schema enforcement does not work on the subscription route, so the contract is enforced in our code.

Where interests conflict (and what the design does about it)

1. **Speed vs traceability.** Analysts want auto-filing; compliance wants every value tied to a page. Design: every value carries its printed row text, deterministic checks gate auto-filing, anything uncertain goes to a review queue with the page.
2. **Capability vs data control.** The hosted model is the best demo; compliance and technology want data in the bank, and Vietnamese law adds cross-border obligations for personal data. Design: public documents only now; the PII ladder (L0 to L3) and an in-bank endpoint are a gate before pilot.
3. **Automation vs verification cost.** If reviewers must re-check everything, savings vanish (f2.ai). Design: reviewers see only flagged documents, and the controls are measured (precision, flagged share) so the review burden is a number, not a hope.

Simulated personas (clearly labelled)

- **[Sim] Senior credit analyst.** "I do not mind the tool reading; I mind not knowing which numbers to trust. Show me the page and the row."
- **[Sim] Credit operations lead.** "If 40 percent of files land in a queue I have to staff, it is worse than today."
- **[Sim] Compliance officer.** "Which model saw this? Which version? Where did the data go? Can I replay the decision?"

- **[Sim] Platform engineer.** "Can I swap the model and the knowledge base without rewriting the pipeline? Who patches it?"

What the numbers in the business case rest on

The workbook defaults (45 min per document, 60% auto-filed, etc.) are placeholders. Public vendor ranges (30 min to 6 h per spread) only bracket the manual-time input; they are not evidence about Techcombank. The values to replace first, in order of impact on the result: manual minutes per document, auto-file share (measure in the pilot), review minutes per flagged document, volume.

Interview guide (30 minutes, one role per call)

All roles: describe the last financial-statement file you handled, from receipt to decision; where did time go? - **Analyst / RM:** how many pages do you read to find the statements? How do you key them (template, system)? What errors have you caught or missed? What would you need to see to trust a pre-filled spread? - **Operations:** monthly volume, rework rate, SLA, how files are named and found, what an exception costs. - **Risk / compliance:** what evidence do you need for an AI-assisted step; which data may go to an external model; who approves a model change; retention and audit expectations. - **Technology:** where documents live, integration points, hosting constraints, what is already approved (models, vector stores, licenses). Record for each: role, date, whether real, three quotes, one number.

Stakeholder interviews: plan and notes

Status: not yet held. The brief asks for at least 5 people across at least 3 roles. Until these rows are filled with real conversations, every stakeholder statement in the memo is labelled as public-source or simulated. Fill one block per conversation; keep quotes verbatim; mark anything you infer as inference.

Who to talk to (5 people, 4 roles)

#	Role	Why this person	Status
1	Corporate credit analyst (user)	Does the spreading and filing today	To schedule
2	Relationship manager, SME or corporate (user)	Collects onboarding documents from customers	To schedule
3	Credit operations lead (process owner)	Owns volumes, SLAs, the filing standard	To schedule
4	Risk / compliance officer	Decides what evidence an AI-assisted step needs and where data may go	To schedule
5	Platform / data engineer (technology)	Knows hosting, approved models, integration points	To schedule

Questions (30 minutes)

All: walk me through the last credit file you handled, from receiving the documents to the decision. Where did the time go? What went wrong?

- **Analyst / RM**: how many documents per file, and which take longest? How do you find the statement pages? How do you key numbers (template, system)? Errors you caught or missed? What would you need to see to trust a pre-filled spread or an auto-filed folder?
- **Operations**: monthly volume by document type; rework rate; SLA; how files are named and found; what an exception costs; how many reviewers could absorb a queue?
- **Risk / compliance**: what evidence is needed for an AI-assisted step; which data may go to an external model; who approves a model change; audit and retention expectations; what would make you stop it?
- **Technology**: where documents live today (DMS, shared drives, LOS); integration points; hosting constraints; approved models and vector stores; licence policy (AGPL?).

Notes template

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### Interview N
- Role / team:                - Date:           - Real or simulated: REAL
- Three verbatim quotes:
  1.
  2.
  3.
- One number (with unit and how they know it):
- Biggest pain:
- What would make them trust / reject the tool:
- Conflict with another role (who, about what):
- Changes this implies for the design or the business case:
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Conflicts log (fill after the interviews)

Between	About	How the design responds